

Week 18: Resurrection

BIG IDEA

Per 1 Corinthians 15, without the resurrection Christianity falls apart, yet many church kids have never heard that there is historical evidence for it. This lesson frames the resurrection as a historical event with better evidence than any rival explanation, then asks students: if you are convinced, what changes?

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- The speaker's students knew Jesus rose but had never considered 1 Corinthians 15's point: cut the thread of the resurrection and everything falls apart.
- Mainline history agrees Jesus existed, was crucified by the Romans, and buried; Paul lists witnesses, the twelve and more than 500, as if saying ask them.
- The intro experience has students consider documented events before their lifetime, the Roman Empire, Alexander the Great, so they see the resurrection as history.
- For a storyteller, find a history professor or buff who tells history well, since the Gospels are historical narrative culminating in Christ's death and resurrection.
- Nothing in history is provable beyond all doubt; the best evidence decides, including here the Bible, Jewish and Roman historians, the Didache, and Clement's letters.
- Rival theories, a swoon, shallow grave, or substituted body, all have less evidence than the resurrection; ask students if convinced, and what must change.

SCRIPTURE

1 Corinthians 15

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What would it mean for Christianity if Jesus had stayed in the grave?
2. How do we know about events like the Roman Empire or the Civil War, and how does the resurrection's evidence compare?
3. Are you convinced the evidence points to Jesus resurrecting? If not, what questions or roadblocks remain?
4. If you are convinced the resurrection happened, what does that mean for your life and what needs to change?

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